CERTAIN-COAST — Letters of Commitment

Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Templates for the organisations to adapt, print on their letterhead and sign. Placeholders are [highlighted].

The NATO SPS call requires a commitment letter from each end-user of a Multi-Year Project. CERTAIN-COAST has five end-users (the water utility, the port authority, the Trans Adriatic Pipeline (TAP), civil protection and the Water Resources Management Agency, AMBU) and a partner-country co-director; two further letters are optional.

The letters

	Letter	Signed by	Status	Sent / received
1	End-user: water utility of the Durrës wellfields	Shoqëria Rajonale Ujësjellës Kanalizime Durrës sh.a.	Required	[to send]
2	End-user: Durrës Port Authority	Autoriteti Portual Durrës (Durrës Port Authority)	Required	[to send]
3	End-user: Trans Adriatic Pipeline AG (TAP)	Trans Adriatic Pipeline AG (TAP), Albania Branch	Required	[to send]
4	End-user: National Civil Protection Agency	Agjencia Kombëtare e Mbrojtjes Civile (National Civil Protection Agency)	Required	[to send]
5	End-user: Water Resources Management Agency (AMBU)	Agjencia e Menaxhimit të Burimeve Ujore (AMBU)	Required	[to send]
6	Partner-country Project Director's institution	Partner-country university or research institute	Required	[to send]
7	Optional: additional NATO co-director's institution	Institution in a NATO member country	Optional	[to send]
8	Optional: Albanian research partner (data and stations)	Albanian geoscience or seismological institute	Optional	[to send]

How to use these templates

1. Send each template to the organisation named in it, with the project summary (Abstract) and the relevant section of the Partnership document.

2. The organisation adapts the text to what it can really commit to, replaces every yellow placeholder, prints the letter on its own letterhead, and has it signed (and stamped, where usual) by a person authorised to commit it.

3. Do not sign on behalf of an organisation and do not send unsigned letters as if they were signed; reviewers check that commitments are genuine.

4. Collect the signed letters as PDF and merge them into one file: the platform (tab 9, End-Users) takes a single PDF with all end-user commitments; keep the originals.

5. What the call asks (2027-1): "an end-user commitment letter for each of the project's end-users"; for governmental end-users the form accepts a letter of support from the ministry or agency. Letters go to NATO in English; an Albanian reading copy of the five end-user letters is in CERTAIN-COAST_Letters_of_Commitment_SQ.docx.

What makes these letters strong

• **Specific and checkable.** Each letter states what the organisation will provide and when, using the months of the Work Plan (access by Month 3, thresholds in Months 13–15, live operation in Months 23–34), so reviewers can see a real plan rather than general support.

• **Security conditions stated up front.** Each end-user letter sets the rules for access and data (restricted tier, review of publications), consistent with the Data Management Plan.

• **Responsibilities clear.** The letters say that the bulletins are advisory, that decisions remain with the operators, and that public warnings remain with the authorities.

• **Looking beyond the project.** End-users state their intention to use the system, adopt procedures and discuss its maintenance after the project, which supports the Sustainability plan.

[Template 1 of 8: End-user: water utility of the Durrës wellfields. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF SHOQËRIA RAJONALE UJËSJELLËS KANALIZIME DURRËS SH.A.]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (wellfields), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Shoqëria Rajonale Ujësjellës Kanalizime Durrës sh.a. supplies drinking water to Durrës from the Fushë Kuqe and Fushë Milot wellfields. Seawater intrusion, land subsidence and the effects of earthquakes on groundwater are real risks to this supply. We therefore support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to our production and monitoring wells for the project's head, conductivity, temperature and barometric loggers, including a conductivity logger in at least one production well of each wellfield, from Month [4] (installed by Month 12);
- our records of groundwater heads, chloride and pumping rates under a data access agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- support for one campaign a year of laboratory chloride samples taken 1, 3 and 7 days apart at agreed wells (analysed at the project's cost);
- staff time to agree the chloride threshold and the acceptable false-alarm rate (Months 13–15) and to develop a joint pumping rule (Months 24–33);
- approval and operational support for a short campaign of safe pumping tests on existing wells, each stopped at an agreed chloride test limit (within Months 24–33);
- participation of [number] staff in the workshops and in the operator training (Months 24–36).

We intend to receive and use the certified intrusion bulletins, including the warning that chloride may cross its limit between two laboratory samples, during the twelve months of live operation (Months 23–34), to issue them ourselves in the final months, and to consider adopting an operating procedure for the system. We are willing to discuss an arrangement for its maintenance after the project.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Shoqëria Rajonale Ujësjellës Kanalizime Durrës sh.a.

[Template 2 of 8: End-user: Durrës Port Authority. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF AUTORITETI PORTUAL DURRËS (DURRËS PORT AUTHORITY)]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (port), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Autoriteti Portual Durrës (Durrës Port Authority) manages the main port of Albania on a subsiding coast exposed to earthquakes, liquefaction and extreme sea levels. We support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to agreed locations in the port for sensors (GNSS, corner reflectors, seismic stations, piezometers), under our port-facility security rules, from Month [4];
- available geotechnical records (CPT and borehole logs) and design levels of the quays under a data access agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- staff time to agree the liquefaction and water-level thresholds (Months 13–15) and to take part in the post-event protocol;
- participation of [number] staff in the workshops and in the operator training (Months 24–36).

We intend to receive and use the liquefaction and extreme-water-level bulletins for the port during the live operation (Months 23–34) and to consider adopting an operating procedure for the system. We are willing to discuss an arrangement for its maintenance after the project.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Autoriteti Portual Durrës (Durrës Port Authority)

[Template 3 of 8: End-user: Trans Adriatic Pipeline AG (TAP). Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF TRANS ADRIATIC PIPELINE AG (TAP), ALBANIA BRANCH]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (TAP landfall near Fier), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Trans Adriatic Pipeline AG (TAP) operates the Trans Adriatic Pipeline. Its landfall near Fier is where the pipeline leaves the Albanian shore for its 105 km offshore section across the Adriatic Sea to Italy. The stability of the landfall depends on the ground and on the sea level at the coast. We support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to agreed locations near the landfall for a small set of sensors (GNSS, corner reflectors, a seismic station and a water-table logger), under our security rules and with our escort, from Month [4];
- the design levels and available geotechnical information needed for the stability checks, under a data access agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- staff time to agree the thresholds for the landfall (Months 13–15);
- participation of [number] staff in the workshops and in the operator training (Months 24–36).

We intend to receive and use the stability bulletins for the landfall, combining shaking, liquefaction, water level and subsidence, during the live operation (Months 23–34), and to consider adopting an operating procedure. We are willing to discuss an arrangement for its maintenance after the project.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Trans Adriatic Pipeline AG (TAP), Albania Branch

[Template 4 of 8: End-user: National Civil Protection Agency. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF AGJENCIA KOMBËTARE E MBROJTJES CIVILE (NATIONAL CIVIL PROTECTION AGENCY)]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (civil protection), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Agjencia Kombëtare e Mbrojtjes Civile (National Civil Protection Agency) is responsible for preparedness and response to disasters in Albania. The Adriatic coast from Durrës to Fier, where the drinking-water wells and the main port of Durrës and the landfall of the Trans Adriatic Pipeline near Fier stand on soft, low and subsiding ground, is a priority for us since the earthquake of 26 November 2019. We support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- a representative on the project steering committee, meeting every six months;
- the triggers for the post-event protocol (earthquake, shaking or water level) and participation in its design;
- participation of [number] staff in the workshops, the operator training and the final demonstration.

We intend to receive the bulletins and post-event reports during the live operation (Months 23–34) and to consider including the post-event protocol in our procedures. Any warning to the public will remain our responsibility and will be issued through our own channels.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Agjencia Kombëtare e Mbrojtjes Civile (National Civil Protection Agency)

[Template 5 of 8: End-user: Water Resources Management Agency (AMBU). Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF AGJENCIA E MENAXHIMIT TË BURIMEVE UJORE (AMBU)]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, end-user (water resources), for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

Agjencia e Menaxhimit të Burimeve Ujore (AMBU, Water Resources Management Agency) manages the water resources of Albania, including the Tiranë–Fushë Kuqe–Lezhë aquifer that supplies Durrës. Seawater intrusion, record droughts and land subsidence threaten this aquifer. We support the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commit to take part as an end-user.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to monitoring wells under our control for the project's level and salinity sensors, bought by the project, using existing wells only (no new drilling), from Month [4];
- our records of groundwater levels, chemistry and abstraction for the aquifer, under a data access agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- staff time to agree the chloride warning threshold and the acceptable false-alarm rate (Months 13–15) and to review the pumping and drought rule (Months 24–33);
- participation of [number] staff in the workshops and in the training on the open software (Months 24–36).

We intend to use the monitoring design, the chloride early warning for each supply well and the pumping and drought rule in [our monitoring programme and water-use permits for this aquifer], and to consider applying the method to other aquifers of Albania. As agreed, our participation creates no obligations of procurement, ownership or maintenance for AMBU.

We are ready to co-sign the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement for the clauses that concern the data we provide and restricted information about our site.

We understand that the CERTAIN-COAST bulletins are advisory: operational decisions remain ours, and any warning to the public is issued only by the competent authorities.

We understand that our participation creates no financial obligation; our contribution is in kind. Data we provide will be treated as restricted, used only under a data access agreement for the purposes of the project, and any publication that uses them will be sent to us for review of sensitive content [30] days before submission.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
Agjencia e Menaxhimit të Burimeve Ujore (AMBU)

[Template 6 of 8: Partner-country Project Director's institution. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF PARTNER-COUNTRY UNIVERSITY OR RESEARCH INSTITUTE]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, partner-country co-director, for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

[Partner-country university or research institute], in [eligible partner country], commits to take part in CERTAIN-COAST as the institution of the partner-country Project Director, [title and name], who is employed by us in [eligible partner country].

In particular, we will provide:

- leadership of training, transfer and dissemination (WP6): two-month exchanges of our early-career researchers on the Durrës coast, a regional workshop and the open release of the results;
- a transfer study of the method on a coast of [eligible partner country], carried out with the project's tools and the Albanian team, using open satellite data and available records;
- a user-side review of the bulletins and operating procedures;
- the salaries of our staff and the use of our facilities and computing, as an in-kind contribution;
- participation of [number] early-career researchers in the project.

We accept the terms of the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project Handbook and of the award, will sign the SPS MYP Agreement for Joint Research and the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement, and will follow the project's data management plan, ethics measures and two-tier dissemination rules.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
[Partner-country university or research institute]

[Template 7 of 8: Optional: additional NATO co-director's institution. Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF INSTITUTION IN A NATO MEMBER COUNTRY]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, additional NATO co-director, for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

[Institution in a NATO member country], in [NATO member country], commits to take part in CERTAIN-COAST as the institution of an additional co-director, [title and name].

In particular, we will provide:

- expertise and supervision for InSAR time-series processing (WP1) and for seismic velocity monitoring with ambient noise (T4.4);
- the salaries of our staff and the use of our facilities, as an in-kind contribution;
- hosting of early-career researchers for training visits.

We accept the terms of the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project Handbook and of the award, will sign the SPS MYP Agreement for Joint Research and the project's Intellectual Property Rights agreement, and will follow the project's data management plan, ethics measures and dissemination rules.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
[Institution in a NATO member country]

[Template 8 of 8: Optional: Albanian research partner (data and stations). Delete this line before printing.]

[LETTERHEAD OF ALBANIAN GEOSCIENCE OR SEISMOLOGICAL INSTITUTE]

[Place], [date]

NATO Science for Peace and Security (SPS) Programme
NATO Headquarters
Boulevard Léopold III
1110 Brussels, Belgium

Subject: Letter of commitment, research partner, for the NATO SPS Multi-Year Project application CERTAIN-COAST: Certified early warning for seawater intrusion, liquefaction and extreme sea levels at the wellfields, port and energy landfall of a subsiding Adriatic coast

Dear Sir or Madam,

[Albanian geoscience or seismological institute] supports the application of CERTAIN-COAST to the NATO SPS Programme and commits to take part as a research partner.

In particular, we will provide:

- access to data from our [seismic, strong-motion and GNSS stations / hydrological and meteorological stations] on the Durrës coast under a data agreement to be signed by Month 3;
- technical support for the installation and upkeep of the project's seismic and GNSS stations;
- participation in the post-event protocol after strong earthquakes or storms.

We intend to continue supporting the geodetic and seismic stations after the project, as foreseen in the sustainability plan, and will follow the project's data management plan and dissemination rules.

Our contact person for the project is [name, position, e-mail, telephone].

Yours faithfully,

[Signature and stamp]
[Name]
[Position]
[Albanian geoscience or seismological institute]